

EARTHQUAKES



Our planet is a restless place. Several hundred times a day, the ground suddenly rumbles and trembles. Most of the movements are so slight that they are not felt. Others bring disaster.

Big cracks appear in the land, streets buckle, and buildings crumble. Whole towns and cities can be destroyed. Then everything settles down but is totally changed. Earth has shaken and an earthquake has happened.

Fires are started by broken gas pipes and broken electrical cables.



Unsafe ground

This is the San Andreas Fault in California. Earthquakes regularly happen here.

Terror from the sea

Earthquakes under the sea can cause long, giant, destructive waves called tsunamis.

Telephone lines brought down

Cars are smashed and they settle at crazy angles.

On this side of the fault the land has moved toward you.



An earthquake occurs along a fault in the seabed.

Tsunamis can travel many miles across the ocean.